Same firm, same page

Language Guidelines for written English at UBS

What's in the Language Guidelines for you

Whether you're communicating with colleagues, clients or other stakeholders, you need to know and apply our standards and norms for English. This is the definitive guide.

Our Language Guidelines enable you to learn and check the binding rules both for specific usage points and for general written style. Follow these guidelines and you'll be able to use language consistently within any channel or document. You'll also support the UBS brand (the way we express ourselves is an important part of this) and help make sure we're all on the same page when it comes to English usage.

These guidelines were developed and agreed to by communications specialists from across the firm. Where there were discrepancies in local usage or preference, a common convention was agreed. While individual business divisions may produce supplemental guidelines, they mustn't contradict the Language Guidelines. And, in cases where special rules apply, you'll see this has been noted.

This is a living document and most recently had a full revision in October 2024. Save this link in your browser's favorites and you'll always have the most up-to-date version.

Our references

Style and usage
The standard reference work at UBS for questions of style and usage not covered in this manual is *The Chicago Manual of Style*, 18th edition. An online version (subject to an annual subscription fee) is available at *www.chicagomanualofstyle.org*.

Spelling
For spelling, we follow *Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary*, 11th edition. A free-of-charge online version is available at *www.merriam-webster.com*.

Note that our guidelines take precedence whenever there's a discrepancy between them and any other reference work.

Our Tone of Voice

Our Tone of Voice complements these language guidelines and helps you write in a way that is clear, convincing and with charm. For more, *goto/toneofvoice/*

Note: US English is our standard.

Other languages

Language Guidelines are available for all four of the main working languages used at UBS. In addition to these English Language Guidelines, we also have:

- *Language Guidelines for written German*
- *Language Guidelines for written French*
- *Language Guidelines for written Italian*

Use

The Language Guidelines are for internal use only, but they can be shared with agencies and other external partners who are working on texts (or producing other content) for UBS.

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1. UBS terminology

1.1. A bank or a firm?

It's correct to refer to UBS as a firm and not a bank. Narrowly defined, several parts of UBS, for example Asset Management, don't provide banking services. Be aware: in some jurisdictions we may be restricted in using the term "bank" by regulators.

However, UBS Switzerland is a bank. Also, clients of UBS in Switzerland consider UBS to be a bank and don't think of it as a firm. Always consider the audience each text is directed at and which parts of the firm you're writing about.

Correct:
2022 was an excellent year for UBS, with the firm's business divisions all producing excellent results.
UBS is the leading universal bank in Switzerland.

Incorrect:
UBS has a second home in the US, where the bank has 20,000 staff.

Prefer *we/us/our* to *UBS/UBS's* or *the firm / the firm's*, never use *our firm's* (phrases such as *our firm's offices* are tautological, i.e. they say the same thing twice, as *our* refers to the *firm*). Don't alternate between *we/us/our* and *UBS / UBS's / the firm / the firm's* in a single sentence.

1.2. Business structure

UBS is divided into five business divisions and a variety of functions. Each business division is divided into business areas.

Some business areas are further divided into business units and client segments, or business lines in Asset Management.

Correct: *business division*
Incorrect: *division, Business group*

1.3. Capitalization of business division and business area, etc.

Don't capitalize generic terms, such as *business division* or *business area*, when referring to UBS's organizational units.

Correct:
There was agreement across all business divisions regarding the usefulness of the language guidelines.

Incorrect:
There was agreement across all Business Divisions regarding the usefulness of the language guidelines.

> According to standard English usage rules, *business division* and *business area* aren't proper nouns, as they aren't names in themselves but are descriptions of parts of an organizational hierarchy.

1.4. Naming rules for UBS businesses, legal entities and joint ventures

Always use the correct names for UBS and its business divisions and business areas in texts (known as communication names).

Use "UBS" or "the Group" or "the UBS Group" to refer to the Group.
Use "UBS Group AG" only if it's required for legal reasons, or to avoid confusion with other entities (e.g. UBS AG).

Correct:
The new regulations require Swiss banks, including UBS, to put in place …
The UBS Group has offices in all major financial centers.
The consolidated financial statements of UBS Group AG and UBS AG are prepared in accordance with IFRS.

Incorrect:
The new regulations require Swiss banks, including UBS Group AG, to put in place …
UBS's and UBS AG's consolidated financial statements are prepared in accordance with IFRS.

The business divisions are

- Global Wealth Management (GWM)
- Personal & Corporate Banking (P&C)
- Asset Management (AM)
- (the) Investment Bank (the IB)
- Non-Core and Legacy (NCL)

When referring to a business division, the words *business division* mustn't be capitalized. Don't use "the" when giving the name of a business division, except for the Investment Bank. Don't refer to Group Functions as a business division. (See *1.3. Capitalization of business division and business area, etc.*).

Write out the full name of a business division. When repeating the name a number of times, introduce the abbreviation in the normal way. (See *2.1. Abbreviations, acronyms and initialisms*). Take care to use the correct abbreviations for business divisions and other business areas/units.

If you need to add UBS to an abbreviation, you must use a hyphen (e.g. *UBS-WMI*): this is a legal and brand requirement.

Don't abbreviate Credit Suisse to "CS", always write out the name as two words with a non-breaking space between them. Use Credit Suisse terminology to refer to former internal units of Credit Suisse. However, when referring to the former Credit Suisse global divisions add "(Credit Suisse)" after the name, e.g. *Asset Management (Credit Suisse)*, *the Investment Bank (Credit Suisse)*, *Swiss Bank (Credit Suisse)* and *Wealth Management (Credit Suisse)*.

There are specific rules for naming UBS entities and joint ventures. Refer to the *UBS Branding and Naming Guidelines* and the *UBS naming overview* for more information.

However, don't refer to UBS legal entities (for example, *UBS Financial Services, Inc.*) but to the respective business division (for example, *Global Wealth Management*) unless such reference is required to comply with local legal regulations. If unsure, check with Legal & Compliance.

1.5. Possessive of UBS? UBS's, never UBS'

Correct:
UBS's employees are highly motivated.

Incorrect:
UBS' employees are highly motivated.

The apostrophe without "s" (for example, the citizens' government) is used to form the possessive of *plural* nouns ending in "s". *Singular* (often proper) nouns ending in "s", such as UBS or Charles, form the possessive with an apostrophe and an additional "s" ('s).

1.6. Private banking

Use the term "wealth management" instead of the term "private banking". If you need to use the term "private banking" for any reason, it must not be capitalized.

Correct but not ideal:
UBS offers a personalized private banking service to clients.

Better:
UBS offers a personalized wealth management service to clients.

Incorrect:
UBS offers clients a personalized Private Banking service.

1.7. Products

Always write the names of UBS products correctly. Don't use hyphens, unless needed to separate UBS from an acronym (e.g. *UBS-ABC fund*).

UBS products always start with UBS and are usually written with initial capital letters, but follow the particular product's usage.

Correct:
UBS Neo, *UBS Portfolio Mortgage, UBS key4, Separately Managed Account*

1.8. Titles of UBS staff

When referring to UBS staff with a title, write name, official function, business division/business area.

As a general rule, don't use professional/academic titles or formal modes of address (Dr., etc.) or Mr. or Ms. (but see the additional comment below). The first time you mention the person, use the given name and family name. For each subsequent mention use the person's given name.

Correct:
John Smith, *head SWIFT transactions office*, *Wealth Management.*

Incorrect:
Dr. John Smith, *director*, *working as head of the SWIFT transactions office in Switzerland.*

Generally, senior management should be referred to in their role as leaders of businesses and not leaders of legal entities. Using academic titles might be appropriate in academic publications, etc.

2. General language guidelines

2.1. Abbreviations, acronyms and initialisms

Abbreviations, acronyms and initialisms should be used with care.

For acronyms/initialisms, always introduce the full term first and put the acronym/initialism in parentheses. Use *the* before the shortened term in parentheses if you would use *the* before the full name in running text, this helps the reader know whether the term is spoken as a word (e.g. *FINMA* is pronounced "fin-mah", i.e. it's an acronym) or as individual letters (e.g. *the SEC* is pronounced "the ess-ee-cee", i.e. it's an initialism). Don't put quotation marks before and after the acronym/initialism. Use only the acronym/initialism in the rest of the text. If a term is used only once, there's no need to introduce its acronym/initialism.

How to introduce an acronym/initialism:
The Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (the SPCA) released a statement today.

Well-known abbreviations, acronyms and initialisms

You don't need to introduce widely known acronyms/initialisms, such as the UN or the EU. After writing *the Federal Reserve* once, it's safe to continue with *the Fed*.

Unnecessary:
The Federal Reserve (the Fed) lowered interest rates yesterday.

In purely internal documents, you don't need to introduce business division initialisms, as these are considered to be well known within the firm. However, introduce initialisms of the Group's functions and operating units that may not be recognized by every member of your audience.

Unnecessary in internal texts:
Asset Management (AM) had a record quarter.

Apostrophes and their use with acronyms/initialisms

Don't use apostrophes with acronyms/initialisms to represent plurals, only to indicate possession.

Correct:
SMEs form the backbone of the economy.

Incorrect:
SME's form the backbone of the economy.

Countries

Country abbreviations are not set off by periods (also known as full stops).

Correct:
The US economic outlook is good.

Incorrect:
The U.S. economic outlook is good.

2.2. Accents and umlauts

Where accents are typically used in English, use them, e.g. *It's déjà vu all over again*.

Avoid using umlauts (two dots over a vowel, e.g. "ü") in English texts. Use the English translation of the word/name if one exists. If not, use the vowel without the umlaut and add an "e" after the vowel.

Don't omit an umlaut without adding an "e" (for example, *Stuerzinger* and *Sturzinger* aren't the same).

An umlaut can also be expressed using the vowel and an "e". The German name "Müller" often appears – correctly – in English as "Mueller". This rule applies to any word with an umlaut. However, be careful with people's names: if a particular person insists on an umlaut being in that person's given name or family name in an English text, use an umlaut.

Correct: *The event took place in the Swiss town of Duebendorf.* (In German, the town is "Dübendorf"). However, write *Zurich* and not *Zuerich* (as the former is the English translation of the latter).

Correct in English: *Michael Mueller*

Incorrect in English (unless requested by the person): *Michael Müller*

2.3. Addresses and place names

Use the local format for addresses. For example, when writing addresses in the US or the UK the number of a building goes before the street name (e.g. *10 Downing Street* or *1600 Pennsylvania Drive*), but when writing a Swiss address the street name goes before the number (e.g. *Bahnhofstrasse 45*).

Don't translate any element of street names. For example, *Paradeplatz* in Zurich is never "Parade place" or "Parade square", and *Alexanderplatz* in Berlin is never "Alexander place" or "Alexander square".

Use the name listed first in Merriam-Webster for places, not other language equivalents.

Correct:	*Warsaw*	*Copenhagen*	*Cologne*	*Lake Geneva*	*Lviv*	*the Eiffel tower*
Incorrect:	Warszawa	København	Köln	lac Léman	Львів	la Tour Eiffel

Note that standard English names can change over time (e.g. *Bombay* is now *Mumbai*, *Kiev* is now *Kyiv*).

For Swiss names that are not listed in Merriam-Webster refer to the Swiss official directory of towns and cities.

2.4. Ampersand (&)

The ampersand (&) represents the word *and*. Ampersands should be avoided and only used in the following cases.

Established formulations

R&B, M&A, F&B, B&B

Proper nouns

Where UBS's business divisions, business areas, etc. style their official name with an ampersand, it should be retained and not replaced with *and*.

Personal & Corporate Banking, Execution & Platform, Derivatives & Solutions, Corporate & Institutional Clients

The same applies for external companies, institutions, entities, etc.: if the official name has an ampersand, do not replace it with the word *and*.

Marks & Spencer, AT&T, Bank Frick & Co. AG

Note: to find out the correct company/institution name, don't rely on the logo alone. That may differ from the official name for presentational reasons. Check how the company writes its name in continuous text.

Tennessee College Access and Success Network (form used in running text)
Tennessee College Access & Success Network (in logo)



Spacing

There's no space before or after the ampersand in initialisms such as *R&D*; in the case of company names, check the official company style.

2.5. *as well as* vs. *and*

and

Use *and* to connect words of the same level of importance.
The initials of the business divisions are AM, GWM, IB, P&C and NCL.

as well as

Use *as well as* to show that a certain item stands out. The effect is similar to "not only *Y* but also *Z*".
We will pay an ordinary dividend, as well as a special dividend.

and plus *as well as*

Use *and* plus *as well as* to list items of the same level of importance while also pointing out an item which stands out. The emphasis is similar to "not only *X* and *Y* but also *Z*".
His presentation addressed the risk profile, the CET1 ratio and corporate governance, as well as the special dividend.

Note: *as well as* cannot be used to replace *and* before the last item in a list. If you use *as well as* to add an additional point after a list, you **must** have *and* before the last item in that list.

Correct:
His firm has offices in London, New York and Paris, as well as a joint venture in Moscow.

Incorrect:
His firm has offices in London, New York, Paris, as well as a joint venture in Moscow.

2.6. Brand names

We avoid brand names and instead use common names (e.g. use *plaster* rather than *Band-Aid*, *tissue* rather than *Kleenex* and *cola* rather than *Coke*). With regard to company names and other similar names, follow the usage of that company/organization (e.g. *the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development*, not the *Organization for* …). Exceptions are made for UBS brand names according to the guidelines given in *1.7 Products*.

Correct:
The 2024 European football championship was held in Germany.

Incorrect:
The UEFA EURO 2024™ was held in Germany.

2.7. Bulleted lists

Be consistent with bullet points. Make them all sentences or phrases or questions with a similar structure. It's best to start each point with either a verb or a noun, action verbs (e.g. *do*, *start*, *use*, etc.) work best. Use the same tense for each verb and capitalize each point the same way.

Bullet points are used to summarize, so avoid making them look like paragraphs. Three lines is a reasonable maximum length, but make them shorter if you can.

If the entries in a bulleted list are made up of single words or very short phrases
- don't capitalize
- don't punctuate

For longer phrases (where no item contains a complete sentence):
- start the list with a colon;
- use semi-colons at the end of each item;
- use *and* (or *or*) after the item before last; and
- use a full stop after the last point.

Entries that are full sentences
- Capitalize the entries as you would any normal sentence.
- End each point with a period (also known as a full stop).

Correct for bulleted lists containing short entries
The offices with the highest potential are
- *Miami*
- *Kuala Lumpur*
- *Karachi*

Correct for bulleted lists with longer items
A correctly styled list that starts with a partial sentence:
- *has no capital letters;*
- *has a semi-colon after each entry except the last one;*
- *has the word "and" (occasionally "or") after the entry before last; and*
- *has a full stop after the last point only.*

Correct for bulleted lists containing complete sentences
There are several things to keep in mind when preparing for Project Alice.
- *The client has very complex problems to solve.*
- *Some components must be handled with extreme care. I cannot emphasize this point strongly enough.*
- *This initial project has the potential for very wide-reaching results.*

2.8. Capitalization

In English, we capitalize as little as possible. In general, only capitalize proper nouns and the first letter of a sentence. Don't capitalize sectors (e.g. *retail*) or categories of investment products (e.g. *global alpha*) or to show that something is important.

Don't capitalize words such as "committee" or "council" when you make a second reference to a body which you have already given the name of (e.g. "We are working with the Swiss Petcare Council on a new project. The council want to …").

The *Board of Directors*, the *Executive Committee*, the *Group Executive Board* and the *Executive Board* are the only UBS boards and committees that have capital letters. Introduce and use *BoD* and *GEB* (and *EB*) rather than writing about "the Board".

Capitalize the names of specific positions, (e.g. *Head Governmental Affairs UK*). Don't capitalize roles (e.g. *team lead*), ranks (e.g. *associate director*) or generic positions (e.g. *financial advisor*). Don't capitalize when referring to multiple similar positions (e.g. *the chiefs of staff from the five business divisions*).

Correct:
John Smith, *the Chairman of the Board of Directors*, *spoke to the press yesterday.* (Chairman of the Board is capitalized)
UBS Chief Executive Officer Jane Smith gave a speech. (title before the name is capitalized)
Incorrect:
John Smith, *Financial Advisor*, *is highly successful.*

Block capitals should be avoided unless part of an individual product name.

2.9. Clients, not customers

Note that UBS has *clients* and not *customers*.

Correct:
We serve our clients around the world via offices in all major financial hubs.
Incorrect:
We serve our customers around the world via offices in all major financial hubs.

2.10. Colons

The colon (:) introduces an element or elements illustrating or amplifying what went before the colon. It has a similar function to words such as *namely*, *for example*, *because*, *therefore*, etc.

Correct:
The main course was followed by a choice of three desserts: apple pie, *ice cream or peach melba.*
She cited an interesting precedent as evidence: the country had already elected a woman and would therefore be willing to elect a member of an ethnic minority.

Capital letters

The first word after the colon is written lowercase.
That is the key to success: always go to bed early and always rise late.

Exceptions apply when the colon is followed by

- a proper noun or word that would otherwise be capitalized
  He spoke three languages: French, *German and English.*
- a direct question
  There was one question on everybody's lips: Who would win the Oscar?
- two full sentences related to the information before the colon
  John had promised himself two things: Firstly, *he would visit his mother every Sunday. Secondly*, *he would be kinder to animals and small children.*

When not to use a colon

A colon isn't always required before a list or series. A colon isn't needed before expressions such as *namely* and *for example*.

Correct:
The shopping list included apples, *pears and oranges.*
Incorrect:
The shopping list included: apples, *pears and oranges.*

Correct:
He usually performed the music of his favorite composers, *for example*, *Schumann*, *Brahms and Liszt.*
Incorrect:
He usually performed the music of his favorite composers: for example, *Schumann*, *Brahms and Liszt.*

2.11. Commas, semicolons and lists

In a list of three or more items, we divide the final two items with *and* or *or* without a comma.

The firm's footprint includes Europe, *Asia and the Americas.*
You can choose from small, *medium or large.*

However, where a comma would aid comprehension (e.g. when one item contains *and* or the list is syntactically complex), adding a comma before the conjunction is good practice.

This will enable you to become an excellent leader of people, *clients*, *and change and results.* ["change and results" is one item.]

During the six-month program, *you will learn how to achieve strategic goals more quickly*, *break down organizational barriers*, *build up your leadership and business skills*, *and change the firm's culture.*

If one (or more) of the items in a list contains a comma (e.g. the legal name of *UBS AG*, *London Branch*), the list must be prefaced with a colon and the items in the list must be separated by semicolons.

Correct:
The US dollar is the functional currency of: UBS Group AG; UBS AG, *London Branch; and UBS's US-based operations.*

Incorrect:
The US dollar is the functional currency of UBS Group AG, *UBS AG*, *London Branch and UBS's US-based operations.*

2.12. Company/entity names

Use singular nouns, pronouns and verb forms to refer to single companies, e.g.

The legal counsel to the plaintiff, *DLA Piper*, *is of the opinion that ….*

Ernst & Young AG has been appointed as auditor.

However, when referring to the people at a company as a collection of individuals, use plural nouns, pronouns and verb forms.

Use the spelling and punctuation of specific institutions and organizations, even when that is different to UBS style.

Correct:
the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
the Antitrust Division of the DOJ
the Scottish Labour party

Incorrect:
the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development
the Anti-Trust Division of the DOJ
the Scottish Labor party

Don't translate or change any part of a company's official legal name. Use, for example, *AG*, *PLC*, *Ltd*, *a.s.*, *S.p.A.*, *Zrt.*, *S.A.*, *GmbH*, *Lda.*, *sp. z o.o.*, *s.r.o.*, *s.a.r.l.*, *s.r.l.*, *kft.*, *s.r.o.*, etc.

2.13. Countries and regions

Refer to *the United States* rather than *America*. Avoid using the word *American* when referring to people or things in the United States, because all people and things of Central, North, and South America are American. An alternative is to use *US* as an adjective and *US residents* or *US citizens* (but only if citizenship is important in the given context) to describe people who live in or are from the US. Always use *the US* and not *the USA*.

Use the name of a country rather than the national adjective when referring to firms or people based or domiciled in that country, e.g. *a UK-based firm* (not a *British-based firm*), *Switzerland-domiciled persons* (not *Swiss-domiciled persons*).

Use *Switzerland* rather than *the Swiss Confederation* unless referring to the legal entity.

When a capitalized geographical term comprising more than one word is used as an adjective before a noun, the term should not be hyphenated, as there is no risk of misreading, e.g. *North Atlantic fog*.

2.14. Currencies

UBS is a financial institution, so clarity when discussing specific amounts of money is extremely important. We operate globally and refer to currencies that may not be familiar to all readers. When writing texts for global audiences or texts that have the potential to be read by global audiences, the primary goal is to be as clear as possible. Always use the ISO code when referring to a specific amount of money, you can find them here: *https://en.wikipefidia.org/wiki/ISO_4217*

Don't use currency symbols, such as $, £, ¥, ₹, ₴, ₽, etc.

Correct:
UBS Switzerland has reduced costs by CHF 0.70 per employee.

Incorrect:
UBS Switzerland has reduced costs by CHF 0.7 per employee. (Amount is unclear.)
UBS Switzerland has reduced costs by 70 rappen per employee. (That currency unit may not be known to all readers.)

ISO currency codes are used before specific amounts and those amounts are always written in digits (the digits can be followed by the words *million*, *billion* or *trillion* when referring to whole large numbers). Add a non-breaking space (made by pressing Ctrl+Shift+Space at the same time) between code and digits. **Never** put currency codes in the middle of numbers.

The fund lost CHF 200 million year on year.
Climate change costs each Swiss taxpayer CHF 400 annually.

In other contexts the currency name should be written out in its full form.
Note that the currency is **not** capitalized (but the name of a country is).

Bonds denominated in Swiss francs and Australian dollars
euro-denominated bonds
He arrived with a mixture of pounds sterling and euro.

2.15. Dates

We use the [day–month–year] style of dates for all global communications.

7 May 2021
Tuesday, *7 May 2021*

The year may be omitted when it's clear from the context.

7 May

Note 1) Don't add a zero for single-figure dates; we **do not** write *07 May* or *07 May 2021*.

Note 2) Don't use a comma between the date, month and year: *7 May 2021*. If the day of the week is mentioned, just one comma is used: *Friday*, *7 May 2021*

Don't use apostrophes to omit the first two digits of years, write them out instead.
Correct: *1970*, *1989*
Incorrect: *'70*, *'89*

Do not use apostrophes when referring to decades.
Correct: *1960s*, *1990s*
Incorrect: *1960's*, *1990's* ("1990's" would refer to something belonging to 1990.)

Write *for the 2021 financial year* (with a *the*) and not *for financial year 2021* or *for 2021 financial year*. The same applies to *performance year*, *award year* and *tax year*.

Continuous text

Dates should be written out in continuous text. The all-numeral form is only appropriate in tables and charts, particularly where space is limited. (See below.)

The company has been listed on the stock exchange since 1 January 2015.
As of 15 August, *Joanna Smith will assume responsibility for all compliance-related matters.*

Dates and punctuation

As mentioned above, a comma is only necessary to separate the day of the week from the date. However, if the date in this form is used in a sentence, a second comma after the year is required.

In fact, *Monday*, *14 June 2010*, *heralded a new dawn for our firm.*

All-numeral dates

You shouldn't use the all-numeral date form in continuous text. But you can use it in tables and charts. The date format is *DD.MM.YYYY* or *DD.MM.YY*. Separate the day, month and year using points, not slashes or dashes: *31.3.2021*; or*31.3.21*.

Abbreviations

Abbreviations of days of the week and months are acceptable only in tables and charts. The below are the established abbreviations that for reasons of consistency should be used at all times. Note that *May*, *June* and *July* aren't abbreviated and that all abbreviations end with a point.

Months

Jan. *Feb.* *Mar.* *Apr.* *May* *June* *July* *Aug.* *Sept.* *Oct.* *Nov.* *Dec.*

Days of the week

Mon. *Tues.* *Wed.* *Thurs.* *Fri.* *Sat.* *Sun.*

2.16. e.g. and i.e.

The abbreviations *e.g.* and *i.e.* are not synonyms. It's important to be aware of the difference and to use them correctly.

e.g. is the abbreviation of the Latin *exempli gratia* and means *for example*;
i.e. is the abbreviation of *id est*, meaning *that is* (or *that is to say*).

Usage

Both abbreviations take two points and are **not** followed by a comma.
In continuous text, it may be better to use the full English equivalents: *for example* and *that is to say*.
The company now offers a range of new services, for example consultancy and building automation.
The partnership will be embarking on a downsizing exercise, that is to say a program of redundancies.

The abbreviations e.g. and i.e. should always be used in parentheses and in notes.
Certain options (e.g. our special discretionary mandates) are available to institutional investors only.
The latest model from BMW (i.e. the F44 2 Series) is selling well.

In continuous text, both abbreviations should be preceded by a comma.
different fruits, e.g. apples, oranges and bananas
the two most important global players, i.e. Putin and Biden

2.17. Ellipsis points

Only use ellipsis points (…) to indicate that a section has deliberately been omitted from a quoted sentence. Avoid overuse and use only for emphasis.

Ellipsis points can be produced by holding down Alt and typing 0133 on the numeric keypad. Leave one regular space on both sides of the ellipsis points, even if they come after punctuation.

2.18. En dashes

The en dash is used primarily to connect numbers (and sometimes words) and to indicate ranges.

En dash

The en dash (–) isn't the same as the hyphen (-). It's longer and produced by holding down Ctrl and pressing minus on the numeric keyboard. Hyphens shouldn't be used to indicate number ranges.

When used with continuing numbers, the en dash has the sense of *up to and including*. There's no space before or after the en dash.
See chapters 10–12.
The years 1914–1918 changed the world forever.
Join us on Thursday, 11:00 a.m.–4:00 p.m., for insights into new investment opportunities.

Note: **do not** use the en dash when the range is preceded by *from* or *between*; use either *to* or *and*.
*She worked at UBS **from** 2012 **to** 2014.*
*He is expected to arrive **between** 08:00 **and** 12 noon.*

En dash as *to*

You can also use the en dash with the sense of *to*.

The Zurich–Milan train leaves in 20 minutes.

En dash in compounds

Some compounds use hyphens, while others use an en dash.

The key to deciding which to use is whether the first half of the compound modifies the second half: if it does, use a hyphen; if it doesn't, use an en dash.

For example: *African-American culture* refers to the culture of Americans who are of African descent. Here *African* is modifying *American*, so the two terms are linked with a hyphen.

However, *African–European discussions* describes discussions between Africa and the EU. In this situation *African* does not modify *European* and both words have equal status/weighting. So an en dash is used.

Note: when the first item cannot stand alone as a word in its own right (typically ending in *-o*), a hyphen is used.
Sino-Russian relations
The Franco-German War
Afro-European culture

Use an en dash, not a hyphen, to form a name made from two (or more) other names.
the Dodd–Frank Act
the Sarbanes–Oxley Act
He moved from the Dallas–Fort Worth metropolitan area to the Illinois–Indiana–Kentucky tri-state area.

Em dash

Don't use em dashes (dashes which are as wide as the letter "m", i.e. —).

2.19. Exclamation points

Use exclamation points with caution and rarely in business communication and writing.

2.20. Footnote and endnote references

Number your footnote and endnote references. Put the reference numbers after the punctuation, e.g. *Pillar 3 report.*[1]
Exception: when a footnote or an endnote reference only applies to text inside parentheses, it goes inside the parentheses.

2.21. Foreign words and expressions

Italics

Foreign words unfamiliar to readers should be set in italics (and not set in quotation marks) and avoided where there's an English alternative expressing the same idea. If they are used frequently throughout the text, they need only be italicized on the first occurrence. If the word or term appears only rarely, italics should be used each time.
For example: The meal started with a selection of delicious *futomaki*.

Another example: The policy of *Lebensborn* was implemented from 1935 onward.

If you're quoting a foreign passage of two sentences or more, this should be set in roman (not in italics) and placed in quotation marks.

Translation/explanation

Translate or explain foreign terms wherever necessary to ensure understanding and set this English translation/explanation in parentheses.

For example: *Fleischkäse* (a type of German meat loaf) is popular throughout the country.

Another example: The Italian tactic of *catenaccio* (or "chain system") remains a strong influence on soccer.

Proper nouns

Foreign proper nouns aren't italicized.

For example: The Concertgebouw is a must-see for visitors to Amsterdam.
Another example: He had a spacious apartment on the rue de Rivoli.

Familiar foreign terms

For the purposes of this guide, familiar foreign terms are those listed in *Merriam-Webster*, e.g. samsara, schadenfreude, élan, zeitgeist, kaiser, mise-en-scène, amuse-bouche, etc. Familiar foreign terms (i.e. those listed in *Merriam-Webster*) are not italicized. If unsure, simply check the dictionary.

Note: German nouns listed in the English dictionary are written all lower case and not capitalized (as they would be in German). For example: David Bowie captured the zeitgeist of five successive decades.

Latin and Greek terms

Commonly used Latin and Greek terms aren't italicized, for example, inter alia, passim, status quo, a priori, de facto, in vitro, eureka, etc.

More obscure or uncommon expressions, including those with a dictionary entry, should be italicized.
For example: The motto of the state of Kansas is *ad astra per aspera*.

Qualifications and professional titles

Don't translate the names of qualifications or professional titles.

2.22. Headlines

We use sentence style, rather than US headline style, for headlines. In other words, capitalization in headlines follows standard rules of English grammar, with only the first letter, proper nouns and any other words that would otherwise be capitalized beginning with a capital letter. Unusual combinations (e.g. *iPad*, *eBay*) aren't changed, even at the start of the sentence.

Washington pulls the plug on Philips deal
Lessons from the past key to Europe's survival
eBay has changed the retail world

Terminal punctuation

Our headlines generally don't end with a period (a full stop). However, a period may be used to add additional emphasis, for example in single-word headlines.

If there's absolutely no alternative to having a headline consisting of two or more sentences (which is rare), all sentences except the last require a period.

Headlines in the form of a question require a question mark.
Have you got what it takes?

Internal punctuation

Internal punctuation within a headline follows the normal rules.

US, Russia and France meet for talks
Albert Stubbins: a man for all seasons
Blockchain – a new era dawns

2.23. Highlighting text

Use red as an accent to the black typography, reserving it for a single word or a short phrase. Don't use red for entire headlines, sentences, etc.

Avoid underlining text. This can make the text look like a clickable link in electronic documents.

You may combine different types of highlighting (e.g. bold with italic) but do so sparingly.

For example: The following policy changes apply only to ***EMEA-based employees***.

2.24. Hyphens

Don't confuse a hyphen with a dash. A hyphen connects words and is short. A dash is longer. (See *2.18. En dashes*)
Hyphenate compound words according to US English usage. If in doubt, check *Merriam-Webster*.

Some general tips:
– When a compound modifier precedes the noun it modifies, use a hyphen; when it comes after, don't.
– Don't use hyphens after adverbs that end *-ly.*
– Use hyphens to avoid ambiguity.
– Financial products or tools denominated by time have a hyphen and a numeral.

Correct:
They realized long-term gains.
They realized gains over the long term.

Use an open hyphen (a hyphen and then a space) when two adjectives combine with another to modify one noun.

They realized short- and long-term gains.
We have carbon- and energy-reduction programs.

Adverb–adjective modifiers with no hyphen

A heavily trafficked road, a very good proposal, a badly chosen example.

Avoiding ambiguity

John will speak to a small business organization has a different meaning to *John will speak to a small-business organization* (in the former the organization is small and focused on business, in the later the organization is focused on small businesses).
A *pickled-herring merchant* is not the same as a *pickled herring merchant* (the former sells preserved fish and the latter may regret certain actions tomorrow).

Time-denominated financial products

3-month money market certificates, 1-day VaR, 5-year US Treasury bonds.

Note here the use of digits for numbers below 10, despite the numbers from zero to nine usually being written as words. For more about this topic, *see 2.31. Numbers*.

2.25. Inclusive language

Words can bring people together. And they can drive people apart. How you say (or write) something matters as much as the point you're trying to get across.

Language has evolved over time, and (some) terms that were commonly used in the past may no longer be acceptable. At UBS, we aim to use and raise awareness of language that makes everyone feel included, and words that are appropriate in the given context. So, whether you know your audience well or not at all, ask yourself the questions below to make sure the language you use doesn't exclude anyone.

1. In the context of your message, do you really need to include details about a person (or group of people) such as gender, sexual orientation, race, religion or socioeconomic background? Does this information add meaning or value?
    - Don't give differing levels of information about different people, e.g. Mrs. Jo Smith, CFO (gender-specific title, less inclusive) vs Robin Meier, CFO (more inclusive).
    - If you can use neutral terms or personal pronouns, use those. Respect a person's stated preference for a specific title or particular pronouns. The table below reflects the options currently available in UBS tools, including where people have the option to state their preferred title/opt out of giving this information. For more about this topic, see *2.33. Personal pronouns*.

DE	EN	FR	IT	ES (ES)	PT (BR)	CHT (Hong Kong)	CHS	JAP
Anrede	Title	Titre	Appellativo	Tratamiento	Título	稱謂	称谓	お選びください
Frau	Ms. (Mrs.)	Madame	Signora	Señora	Sra./Srta.	太太/女士	太太/女士	女性
Herr	Mr.	Monsieur	Signore	Señor	Sr.	先生	先生	男性
Weitere / Anderes	Other	Autre	Altro	Otros	Outra opção	其他	其他	その他
Keine Angabe	Prefer not to say	Non précisé	Preferisco non rispondere	No sabe/no contesta	Prefiro não dizer	拒答	不愿作答	回答しない

2. Female versus woman/women

In the use of *female* versus *woman/women*, it all comes down to adjectives and nouns.

While *female* is an adjective generally more appropriate in biological- or gender-based descriptions (e.g. male/female/non-binary for a form), *woman/women* is a noun more commonly used in a factual setting to describe an adult (e.g. there are three women in my team). Using *females* as a noun to refer to people can carry negative connotations and cause offence.

There continue to be many discussions as the use of language changes. The biggest question to ask is whether it's necessary to include the information at all; does it add value or correctness to specify the gender of the person you're talking about in the given setting (e.g. does your audience need to know the question came from a female or male investor, or simply from an investor)?

3. Have you used ableist language, i.e. words that could be perceived as negative about people with disabilities? About 70% of disabilities are invisible and there are many types. They can be permanent, temporary or situational.
4. The language we use around disabilities shouldn't imply stereotypes, pity, or otherwise negative connotations. For example, " suffers from" or " is a victim of". See more on people-first language below.
    - Don't make assumptions about or use language that implies what a person can (or can't) do based on physical appearance or what you think you know about a condition.
    - As far as possible, use people-first language, focusing on the person, not the disability, by placing a reference to the person or group before the reference to the disability. For example, by using expressions such as
        - *children with albinism*
        - *students with dyslexia (or other Neurodiverse traits)*
        - *persons with disabilities*

5. Have you used any words or biased expressions that could be interpreted as workplace (or other) stereotypes?
   For example
   "In a manly way."
   "Oh, that's women's work."
   "Men just don't understand."
6. Have you used any words simply because you always have, without ever thinking about their possible undertones?

- Be aware that some commonly used phrases can cause offence, and that the meanings and connotations of language can change over time, (e.g. "It's a witch hunt!" or "My boss is a real slave driver!").
- Be conscious of how you use colloquialisms and idioms in a culturally diverse environment: they can occasionally be unfamiliar to and, as a result, misunderstood or misinterpreted by people from another background (e.g. "The point got lost in a game of Chinese whispers." or "It's blacklisted." or "The media would lynch us for doing that.").
- Words may have origins you are not aware of, e.g. *to grandfather* comes from *grandfather clauses* used in the past in some US states to deny the vote to Black people while exempting people (mainly lower-income white people) from educational, property or tax requirements for voting if their grandfathers/fathers had been able to vote before 1867.

Note: inclusive language continues to be an important theme as we develop our guidelines on how to communicate.

2.26. Italics – names and titles

Proper names and titles in the following categories should be set in italics.

Books

Oliver Twist, The Hobbit, Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone
Exception: the Bible (and its constituent sections and books) and other central religious works, such as the Koran and the Talmud, are set in roman, not italics; however, specific translations of the Bible are italicized, *e.g. the New English Bible.*

Newspapers, magazines and periodicals

Financial Times, *Handelsblatt*, *Neue Zürcher Zeitung*, *UBS Investor Watch*

Note: the the in English-language newspaper and magazine titles (apart from *The Economist*, *The Times* and *The New York Times*) is lowercased and set in roman. Foreign articles that form part of the title are capitalized and italicized.

For example: "I read it in the *Guardian*, although it first appeared in the *Daily Mail*."
For example: "She subscribes to *Die Presse* and *Le Monde*."

Poems

Long poems, typically those comprising multiple parts or making up a book are italicized; however, shorter poems are set in quotation marks.

T.S. Eliot's *Waste Land*, Dante's *Divine Comedy*, Carol Ann Duffy's "Warming Her Pearls"

Plays and operas

Macbeth, *The Mousetrap, Die Fledermaus, The Mikado, HMS Pinafore*

Reports

Separate stand-alone reports (and recurring series of stand-alone reports, see *Newspapers, magazines and periodicals above*) are italicized; reports that are contained within a larger work, such as a book or a magazine, are placed in quotation marks.

- UBS recently published *Climate change: a risk to the global middle class.*
- The third report prepared by the Enhanced Disclosure Task Force presents the progress made in application of the recommendations in its first report, *Enhancing the Risk Disclosures of Banks*.
- For more on the subject of business and climate change, read "Unsustainable Developments" in *The Economist*.

Movies, TV shows, radio shows

Lost in Translation, *Star Wars*, *South Park*, *Star Trek*, *The Archers*, *Test Match Special*

Blogs

Blog names, but not individual blog entries, are set in italics.

For example: John updated his travel blog, *Around the World in Eighty Beers*, each week.

Music albums

Faith, *A Night at the Opera*, *Impossible Princess*

Note: individual songs are placed in quotation marks, e.g. "Faith" is a song on the album *Faith*.

Artwork

Guernica, Michelangelo's *David*

Exception: works from antiquity are set in roman, e.g. the Venus de Milo

Cartoon strips

Peanuts, *Garfield*, *Doonesbury*

Exhibitions

UBS and Annie Leibovitz have teamed up to create the *WOMEN: New Portraits* exhibition.
A Golden Age, an exhibition of 17th-century Dutch art, will run until mid-March.

Ships and other named vessels (planes, spacecraft, etc.)

Cutty Sark, *Santa Maria*, the space shuttle *Challenger*, the *Spirit of St. Louis*

Note: preceding abbreviations (e.g. HMS, USS, SS) are not italicized: HMS *Victory*, USS *Enterprise*

Scientific Latin names for flora and fauna

Narcissus pseudonarcissus, *Felis catus*, *Vombatus ursinus*, *Dracaena cinnabari*

Legal cases

Legal cases cited in the following form are italicized in nonlegal texts of a general nature. Writers working on specialist legal texts should follow appropriate legal style guidelines.

For example: I refer you to the reply given in the matter of *Arkell vs. Pressdram*.

2.27. Line breaks and word divisions

Whenever possible, line breaks should be avoided, as excessive use can easily make even the best texts tiresome to read. If, however, it's unavoidable, follow these guidelines.

Word division

Words should be divided following the break or breaks indicated in *Merriam-Webster*. For example, the dictionary tells us that *progressive* can be divided as follows: pro•gres•sive. Dividing words other than as recommended can lead to misreading and also interrupt the flow of the text.

Words and expressions that shouldn't be divided

Single-syllable words and words that would require a one-letter division, e.g. *alone*, *enough*, *unite*, are never divided. Numbers and abbreviated units of measure, e.g. *36 km*; *6:20 a.m.*; *CHF 30*, are also never divided.

Proper nouns

Proper nouns consisting of more than one element should be broken between those elements, if possible.

2.28. Logos

Never use the UBS logo in a sentence or in running text.

Never use any third-party logos or trademarks in texts, unless, for example, it's a requirement of a sponsorship relationship.

Incorrect:
It was a strong quarter for UBS.

2.29. Mathematical expressions

This section is designed to help writers using everyday mathematical expressions in general texts. For more specialized texts, please consult chapter 12 of *The Chicago Manual of Style*.

The most common signs and the corresponding Alt codes are listed in the table below. Please note that the minus and multiplication signs are not the hyphen (-) and letter x as found on the standard keyboard. To produce these signs, hold down Alt and then type the appropriate number on the numeric keyboard.

+	plus (Alt + 43)
–	minus (Alt + 0150); do not use a hyphen as a minus sign
×	multiplication (Alt + 0215); don't use the letter x instead of ×
÷	division (Alt + 0247)
<	less than (Alt + 60)
>	greater than (Alt+ 62)
=	equals (Alt + 61)
≤	less than or equal to (Alt + 8804)
≥	greater than or equal to (Alt + 8805)
≠	not equal to (Alt 8800)
≈	almost equal to (Alt + 247)
±	plus or minus (Alt + 0177)
°	Degree symbol (Alt + 0176) Note: no space between the number and the symbol, e.g. 31.5°C.

Alternatively, insert special characters by clicking on Ω Symbol (under the Insert tab) and selecting the character(s).
Using these signs instead of written-out phrases is not recommended.
Unclear: *>70% mobile device transactions are made using mobile devices.*
Clear: *More than 70% of transactions are made using mobile devices.*

2.30. Mathematical signs and spacing

Operational signs representing a verb (e.g. = [equals]; < [is less than]) or a conjunction (e.g. + [plus]; – [minus]) use normal interword spacing.

4 + 6 = 10; x – y = z

Signs representing an adjective (i.e. acting as a modifier) don't have a space after them.

–5; ×12; >93

2.31. Numbers

Whole numbers from zero up to and including nine should be written out. Numerals should be used for all other numbers (i.e. from 10 upward).
My house is five years old.
My brother is 10 years old.

Numbers under ten including a decimal fraction are written with numerals.
An inch is equivalent to 2.54 centimeters.

Use only commas as thousand/million/billion separators.
1,000; 50,000; 100,000; 1,000,000

With one to nine hundred or thousand it's possible to either use words or figures, e.g. 300 or three hundred. However, don't mix figures and hundred/thousand (e.g. don't write *300 thousand* or *15 hundred*) and always be consistent (e.g. don't write *staff headcount increased by six hundred to just under 4,000*).

If using multiple numbers in the same sentence, use the same format for all.

Correct:
Attendees were split into groups of three or four.
Each conference had 200–300 participants.
Some people had only three and others had more than three hundred.

Incorrect
Some people had only three and others had more than 300.

Large numbers (millions, billions, etc.)

In nonscientific continuous text, million, billion, etc., should be written out. Modifying numbers follow the rule above.
The city has a population of one million.
The region has a population of 4.5 million.
The country has a population of 66 million.

Write out the words *million*, *billion* and *trillion*.
Use *mn*, *bn* or *trn* only in tables or graphics where there isn't enough space to write the word.
Never use *k* to mean thousand, not even in tables (instead just put all the digits).

Numbers that start a sentence

Numbers that start a sentence should always be written out.
Thirty-six people went to the party.

However, it's generally preferable to avoid starting a sentence with a number. Reformulate the sentence if possible.
There were 36 people at the party.

You can, however, start a sentence with a year. The year is still written in digits.
2023 was a memorable year for UBS.

Ordinal numbers

Ordinal numbers follow the same rule as cardinals: ordinals up to and including ninth are written out; all others are given as numerals. Note: the letters in ordinal numbers (st, nd, rd, th) should not be superscripted.

The first day of the year
The company's 150th anniversary

Exception: centuries should always be spelled out.

Roman culture in the third century
The English novel flourished in the nineteenth century.

Fractions

Simple fractions are spelled out and hyphenated.

A two-thirds majority is required.
She has read three-fifths of the book.

However, when the individual parts are emphasized, no hyphen is used.
The cake was cut into four quarters and he took three of those. (He took three pieces of cake, each of which was a quarter of the whole.)

2.32. Percentages

Use the percent sign

Use the percent sign and digits for all numbers, including whole numbers from 1% to 9%.
The rate of inflation was 18.4% in Poland, 8% in Germany and 3.4% in Switzerland.

Don't start sentences with a percentage or digits. Don't write out a percentage as a word.

Spacing

Don't put a space between the number and the percent sign: *5%*, not *5 %*.

Ranges

In ranges using the percent sign, the sign must be repeated.
5% to 10%, *5%–10%*

Fractions of percent

Avoid using per-mille. Write, for example, *0.3%* and not *3‰*.

2.33. Personal pronouns

Avoid gendered pronouns unless referring to a specific person whose preferred pronouns you know.
A better option to using *he* or *she* may be to write your sentence using plural forms.
Not an option:
Reply immediately to your client if he applies in person.
Better:
Reply immediately to clients who apply in person.

Alternatively, it may be possible to use the pronoun *one*.
Not an option:
A branch manager in Russia earns less than he would in Switzerland.
Better:
A branch manager in Russia earns less than one in Switzerland.

It might be possible to rewrite a sentence using the pronoun *who*.
Not an option:
If a client is not satisfied with the bank's decision, he can complain to the banking ombudsman.
Better:
A client who is not satisfied with the bank's decision can complain to the banking ombudsman.

Sometimes it's possible to replace a pronoun by using *the* or *a/an*.
The applicant needs to provide documentation supporting his application. can be rewritten as *The applicant needs to provide documentation supporting the application.*

It might be possible to omit the pronoun without changing the meaning of a sentence.
Not an option:
An employee's bonus bracket depends on his seniority.
Better:
An employee's bonus bracket depends on seniority.

Sometimes one can simply repeat a noun instead of using a pronoun.
Not an option:
A director may request such documentation be sent to his address.
Better:
A director may request such documentation be sent to the address of that director.

Using *they* as a singular pronoun for a single person of an unknown/unspecified gender is becoming increasingly acceptable, especially for informal communication, as it avoids non-inclusive language, such as *he/she*.

A specific person's stated preference for a specific pronoun must always be respected.

2.34. Quotation marks and punctuation

Use double quotation marks when quoting text. Use single quotation marks only when a quotation contains another quotation. Follow this pattern for further enclosures (i.e. double quotation marks when a quotation contains another quotation which itself contains a third quotation, single for quotations inside the aforementioned, and so on). Don't use guillemets (e.g. »*German uses guillemets like this.*« «*French uses them like this.*» «*So does Swiss German!*»).

For punctuation marks, we follow Logical Punctuation quotation style: punctuation marks are placed inside the quotation marks only if the sense of the punctuation is part of the quotation. Anything that isn't part of the quoted text isn't put inside the quotation marks. This is because we do not change what people actually said or wrote when we quote them (otherwise it isn't a quotation).

For example, if the Chairman is asked "Does the firm have any plans to [XYZ]?" and the reply is simply "No.", we write:
When asked if the firm has any plans to [XYZ], the Chairman said "No."

But if the reply to that same question is "No, we have no such plans right now, but we don't rule it out entirely, and I suppose it's not entirely impossible that we might re-assess our stance over sometime in the next decade." we write:
When asked if the firm has any plans to [XYZ], the Chairman said "No".

The same applies to all other punctuation: if it is part of the quoted text, it goes inside the quotation marks; but if it is not part of the quoted text, it goes outside the quotation marks.

A question mark that belongs to the surrounding text is placed outside the quotation marks.
Which Shakespeare character said "Now is the winter of our discontent"?

But a question mark that belongs to the quoted text is placed inside the quotation marks.
She turned to me and asked "Do you know who that man is?"

The same applies to exclamation points: when one is part of the quoted text, it goes inside the quotation marks.
President Kennedy famously exclaimed "Ich bin ein Berliner!"
But when the exclamation point is not part of the quoted text, put it after the quotation marks
He is now earning six million dollars a year "plus expenses"!

Please note: when the question mark / exclamation point appears inside the quotation marks, no period follows it.

There is no need to put any additional punctuation before a quotation purely to tell the reader a quotation is coming (that's what quotation marks are for). But quotation marks don't mean you can leave out other necessary punctuation, for example a comma after an introductory clause.

For example
As Thomas Edison put it, "Genius is 1% inspiration and 99% perspiration." [the comma follows an introductory phrase]
but
Thomas Edison said that "Genius is 1% inspiration and 99% perspiration." [no punctuation needed]
and
"Genius", observed Thomas Edison, "is 1% inspiration and 99% perspiration." [two commas as bracketing commas]

Note that a comma that is part of a quotation goes inside the quotation marks.
For example

"Winston," said Lady Aston, "if I were your wife, I'd poison your coffee." [the first comma follows an introductory phrase]
"And if I were your husband," replied Mr. Churchill, "I would drink it." [the first comma follows a conditional clause]

2.35. Slashes

The slash (*/*), also known as the forward slash or solidus, has a number of different uses.
Please note that there is no space before or after the slash if there's only one word on either side of the slash, e.g. *Add the person's title e.g. Mr./Ms*.

However, if there are at least two words on at least one side of a slash, there's a space before and after the slash, e.g. *going to / returning from the office*.

Alternatives

The slash can be used to indicate alternatives and stands for the word *or*. It's also used to indicate alternative spellings or names.

The selected applicant/applicants will then be invited to appear before the committee.
The Hercules/Heracles myths are deeply rooted in Western imagination.
Please show your passport and/or ID card to the desk officer as required.

The slash can also be used with the sense of *and*, though usually with a sense of alternatives.
The program is an ideal refresher/introductory course.

Time spans

The slash can be used to indicate only time spans which run from one year into the next. It's not used for spans covering more than two years.

The winter of 1978/79 is widely remembered as the Winter of Discontent.

Dates

Slashes are often used in the all-numeral US date format, e.g. *7/11/93*. We don't use this format, except in a very limited number of specific expressions, such as *9/11*.

Abbreviations

The slash is also used in certain abbreviations. Some common examples are listed below; however, always check *Merriam-Webster* and use the entry listed there.
a/c (account); *c/o* (care of); *24/7* (24 hours a day, 7 days a week)

2.36. "So-called" and "according to"

The expression *so-called* expresses irony, doubt or skepticism. It's best avoided unless you wish to imply that something has been improperly named.
The so-called Ministry of Truth was actually dedicated to propaganda and rewriting history.

"According to" means "as reported by" or "as stated by" and refers to an opinion that is not that of the writer. As this phrase can also be used in an ironic, doubtful or skeptical sense, it's best to avoid it when attributing wording to a UBS employee expressing their professional opinion on behalf of UBS; opt simply for "says" instead to remove any possible ambiguity.

Use: *Emerging market equities can achieve around 15% earnings growth*, *says John Smith*, *CFO, AnyCorp.*
Avoid: *Emerging market equities can achieve around 15% earnings growth*, *according to John Smith*, *CFO, AnyCorp.*

2.37. Spelling

If you're in any doubt about the spelling of a word, check *Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary*. When a word has variant spellings, use the spelling listed first in *Merriam-Webster*.

Never rely solely on the spell-checking system of your computer, as this will ignore correctly spelled words that have been incorrectly used. Some examples: *form* and *from*, *message* and *massage*, *manager* and *manger*.

2.38. Times of day

Use the 24-hour clock in business texts, e.g. *13:50*. Separate the hours and minutes with a colon as in the example, and add a leading zero where necessary, e.g. *09:05*.

In more personal texts, such as client invitations to events, use "a.m." and "p.m." Both take points and are preceded by a space. In the interests of consistency, the minutes (*:00*) should be included when giving full hours, as in the first example below.

9:00 a.m.
10:15 a.m.
11:30 p.m.

Midnight and midday

By convention, 12:00 a.m. (ante meridiem) is midnight and 12:00 p.m. (post meridiem) is midday. However, not all readers will be aware of this and may well misunderstand what is meant. So use *12:00 noon* and *12:00 midnight*.

Punctuation

When a sentence concludes with a time of day written using "a.m." or "p.m.", no second period should be added.
The dinner is scheduled to start at 7:30 p.m.

Otherwise, normal punctuation rules apply.
Please register at reception after 8:00 a.m., *where you will receive your guest passes.*

Time zones

In texts aimed at an international audience – announcing a press conference to be broadcast worldwide, for example – you can avoid misunderstandings by including the relevant time zones. In these cases, use the standard abbreviations.
14:30 CET, 10:15 CEST

2.39. Titles (honorifics)

The most often used titles for people are *Mr.* and *Ms.* Even though *Ms.* is not an abbreviation, it's always followed by a full stop. Use *Mrs.* only to refer to a woman you are sure prefers that title (e.g. because she signs her name "Jane Doe (Mrs.)").

2.40. Typography

Quotation marks and apostrophes

Professional typography requires the use of typeset (also known as "directional", "smart" or "curly") quotation marks and apostrophes. The vertical marks (' and ") employed as standard on keyboards aren't appropriate. The typeset "smart" marks are easily added using the corresponding Alt codes or by altering your keyboard settings.

Alt codes

" Alt + 0147 (this is an opening double quotation mark)

" Alt + 0148 (this is a closing double quotation mark)

' Alt + 0146 (this is an apostrophe and also a closing single quotation mark)

' Alt + 0145 (this is an opening single quotation mark)

Do not use straight quotation marks and apostrophes unless made necessary by a technological limitation.

Italics and surrounding punctuation

Punctuation adjacent to italicized text is set according to the following rules.

- **Punctuation is part of italicized text**
  When the punctuation is a constituent part of the italicized text, it too is set in italics.
  For example: He spent the morning listening to *Help!* by the Beatles. (*Help!* is the title of the album.)
  Another example: Edward Albee wrote *Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf? (Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf?* is the name of the play.)
- **Punctuation is part of surrounding text**
  When the punctuation belongs to the surrounding text, it's set in roman.
- **Apostrophe (+ s)**
  When the apostrophe and the following *s* are not part of the italicized matter, they are set in roman.
  For example: The *Wall Street Journal*'s editorial page focuses on the day's major issues.
  Another example: HMS *Victory*'s maiden voyage
- **Plurals with s**
  The same principle applies in the case of plurals.
  I have hundreds of *Economist*s on my bookshelves at home.
- **Parentheses**
  Parentheses enclosing italicized matter are set in roman.
  The common grass snake (*Natrix natrix*) is perfectly harmless.
- **Superscript and subscript**
  Superscript and subscript symbols (in most cases a number or letter) are written above or below, and to the right or left of another character. Some common examples are
  - m^2 (square meters)
  - CO_2 (carbon dioxide)
  - UBS Manage™ (UBS Manage trademark)

2.41. Units, weights and measurements

Space permitting, units, weights and measurements should be written out in full in continuous text.
The railroad stretches over 800 miles.
The cargo weighed 12 tonnes.

Abbreviations

Use abbreviations in tables and charts. A space is inserted between the figure and the abbreviation.
12 cm, *16 kWh*

Hyphenation

The normal rules of hyphenation apply. Note: the noun is singular when used in such modifying structures.
An 800-mile railroad
A 12-tonne cargo

A six-inch-high statue

No hyphen is inserted when the abbreviation is used.
A 12 cm statue
A 500 km highway

Metric (SI) units

Use the US English spellings of *millimeter*, *centimeter*, *meter* and *kilometer.*
Use the US English spellings of *milliliter*, *centiliter*, *deciliter* and *liter.*

However, the SI unit equal to 1,000 kilograms is spelt *tonne*. The US unit equal to 2,000 pounds is spelt *ton* (sometimes referred to as a *short ton*). The (much less common) British unit equal to 2,240 pounds is the *Imperial ton* or the *long ton*. You may find it is better to use *metric ton* rather than *tonne*, as it is less likely to be confused with a *ton* or an *Imperial ton.*

The abbreviations of SI units are lower case (e.g. 6 kg, 10 m, 7.5 t, 0.5 l, etc.) except for units named after specific people, e.g. ampere (A), volt (V), Kelvin (K), Newton (N), hertz (Hz), pascal (P), Celsius (°C), etc.

Ranges

When indicating ranges, only give the unit once.
10 to 12 km
10–12 km

However, when the symbol/sign is written closed up to the number, it must be repeated.
10°C to 30°C
25%–35%

2.42. US English is our standard

We use US English. This is especially important for Group-wide, global and employee communications.

We allow exceptions when dealing with client, marketing or other external communications solely intended for regions that follow another standard. However, don't mix US English with other varieties of English.

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